



Maryland Association of Election Officials

Representing the Local Election Boards of the State of Maryland

February 12, 2026

Michael Summers, Chairman, State Board of Elections

Dear Chairman Summers and Board Members,

The Maryland Association of Election Officials (MAEO) is the professional membership organization representing local election officials and election boards across all 24 jurisdictions in the state. Our members are dedicated to ensuring the smooth and effective administration of elections, and we are deeply committed to making Maryland elections accessible, secure, and fair.

The MAEO Board and membership met to discuss the proposed regulations that govern Challengers and Watchers, *COMAR 33.07.07.01* through *.03*. During the meeting, the MAEO Board in attendance voted in support of submitting these comments. In addition, all local boards in attendance (21) voted in support of submitting these comments.

Currently, *COMAR 33.07.07.01D(4)* states:

“A designating entity shall provide the local board with:

- (a) Copies of completed certificates; or
- (b) A list of individuals designated as challengers and watchers.”

This regulation has always been in place, but it has not been followed consistently. In our experience, it is very rare that designating entities provide the local board with copies of completed certificates or a list of individuals who have been designated as challengers and watchers.

In the proposed regulation, a deadline was imposed to make sure that designating entities comply with this regulation. The deadline would allow election offices to notify the chief judges assigned to the voting location to expect a challenger and watcher specifically by their name. It also allows the election office to keep a copy of the challenger and watcher form for our records in the case that an emergency happens at a voting location. This is not an effort to prevent or hinder Challengers and Watchers from being at voting locations, but an effort to make sure that we can prepare and accommodate their presence so that they can best further their mission.

The safety and security of election judges, staff, voters, equipment, and voting locations is one of our highest priorities. Election judges are identified, assigned, and trained in advance. Voters and candidates are subject to rules and regulations of proper decorum. In addition, board members and staff members are identified in the voting location upon entry. We believe that challengers and watchers should be included in our process to ensure a safe and efficient voting area. Passage of the proposed deadline in the final regulation will provide us with proper documentation and confidence that whoever is in the voting location is safe.

We would like to thank the State Board for accepting our comments on these proposed final regulations. On behalf of MAEO, we kindly ask that you reconsider the passage of these final regulations.

Sincerely,

Erin Perrone

Erin Perrone
MAEO, President
Carroll County

Stephanie L. Taylor

Stephanie Taylor
MAEO, Vice-President
Harford County

Abigail Goldman

Abigail Goldman
MAEO, Secretary
Baltimore City

Tae M Frere

Tae Frere
MAEO, Treasurer
Saint Mary's County

Barry E. Jackson

Barry Jackson
MAEO, Board Member
Washington County

Jessica Noranbrock

Jessica Noranbrock
MAEO, Board Member
Dorchester County

Reider White II

Reider White
MAEO, Board Member
Anne Arundel County

Teresa Womble

Teresa Womble
MAEO, Board Member
Howard County

cc: Jared DeMarinis, State Administrator
Katherine Berry, Deputy State Administrator

Audit trail

Details

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Activity

SENT	erine.perrone@maryland.gov sent a signature request to: - Stephanie L. Taylor (stephanie.taylor@maryland.gov) - Barry E. Jackson (barry.jackson@maryland.gov) - Abigail Goldman (abigail.goldman@baltimorecity.gov) - Erin Perrone (erine.perrone@maryland.gov) - Reider White II (reider.white@maryland.gov) - Tae M Frere (tae.frere@maryland.gov) - Jessica Noranbrock (jessica.noranbrock@maryland.gov) - Teresa Womble (teresa.womble@maryland.gov)
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Signed by Tae M Frere (tae.frere@maryland.gov)

2026/02/13
13:49:16 UTC



Signed by Jessica Noranbrock (jessica.noranbrock@maryland.gov)

2026/02/13
13:25:05 UTC



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2026/02/13
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